The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

PUBLIC HEALTH & STATE POWER
Roman civic governance → Medieval municipal neglect → 1848 Public Health Act (L1, L2, L4)

SANITARY ENGINEERING & TECH
Roman aqueducts → Lead piping → Bazalgette's brick sewer network (L1, L6)

ETIOLOGY & SCIENTIFIC EMPIRICISM
Divine retribution & Miasma → John Snow's Broad St map → Germ Theory (L3, L5)

WORKING-CLASS ACTIVISM & RIGHTS
Polluted town riots → Water rate strikes → Public demand for health infrastructure (L2, L4)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **How much progress did the Romans make in public health?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: CHANGE & CONTINUITY / CAUSATION	• Explain how Roman aqueducts and conduits transported freshwater into towns using gravity. • Evaluate whether Roman sanitation was motivated by genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: If the Romans possessed no electric or steam pumps, how did they move millions of gallons of water over thirty miles of countryside?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why the Romans built sophisticated water supply and sanitation systems in Britain after AD 43. [12 marks]**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 **Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: COMPARISON & LIVING CONDITIONS / CAUSATION	• Contrast living conditions in crowded medieval towns with clean monastic complexes. • Assess how the Black Death (1348) challenged medieval ideas about health and disease. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: If medieval monks could build settling tanks and lead water pipes, why didn't neighbouring townspeople copy their technology?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why living conditions and public health in medieval towns were so much worse than in medieval monasteries. [12 marks]**
Lesson 3 **To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: EXTENT OF CHANGE / SOURCE UTILITY	• Explain why Sir John Harington's 1596 flush toilet failed to transform national sanitation. • Assess what Samuel Pepys' diary reveals about domestic living conditions in Stuart London. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Why was an Elizabethan flush toilet practically useless without municipal water mains and sewers?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] 'Early Modern towns made substantial progress in water supply and sanitation between 1500 and 1700.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]**
Lesson 4 **How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: CAUSATION & LIVING CONDITIONS	• Explain how industrial boomtowns created back-to-back housing and water squalor. • Evaluate why the 1848 Public Health Act failed to solve the crisis. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Why did speculative landlords build back-to-back houses rather than detached homes with gardens and drains?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why public health in industrial towns deteriorated into a national crisis in the period 1800–1850. [12 marks]**
Lesson 5 **Why did it take the 'Great Stink' to finally clean up Britain's streets?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: CAUSATION & TURNING POINTS	• Explain how the Great Stink of 1858 overcame political laissez-faire in just eighteen days. • Evaluate the engineering achievements of Joseph Bazalgette and their long-term significance. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Why did Victorian MPs ignore cholera epidemics in slums for twenty years, but pass a sewer bill in eighteen days when the smell entered Parliament?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865); Source A: "Father Thames Introducing His Offspring to the Fair City of London" (Punch, 1858) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why the British government finally took decisive action to build London's sewer network after 1858. [12 marks]**
Lesson 6 **Why did it take the scientific revolution of Germ Theory to finally conquer water-borne disease?** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: HISTORICAL INVESTIGATION & EPIDEMIOLOGICAL EVIDENCE	• Explain how Dr John Snow used scientific detective work and his 1854 spot map to locate the source of cholera. • Assess why medical authorities resisted Snow's findings, and how Germ Theory finally vindicated him. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Why was the survival of seventy brewery workers drinking malt beer the most convincing proof of Snow's water-borne theory?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs; Source A: Dr John Snow's Spot Map of the Broad Street Cholera Outbreak (1854) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why Dr John Snow's investigation of the 1854 Broad Street cholera epidemic was a decisive turning point in medicine. [12 marks]**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 7 **November Assessment Masterclass: Rapid Progress in Public Health (1800–1900)** 🎯 DISCIPLINARY SKILL: CAUSAL EXPLANATION & STRUCTURED PEEL SYNTHESIS	• [object Object] • [object Object] • [object Object] *Discussion Prompt: Which of the four catalysts provided the absolute legal compulsion that forced every local council to act?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Dr John Snow's 'Grand Experiment' Comparative Mortality Table (1854); Source B: Construction of London's Intercepting Sewers (1861); Source C: Robert Koch's Identification of the Cholera Bacillus under the Microscope (1884/1897) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain why there was rapid progress in Public Health between 1800 and 1900. [12 marks • 30 mins] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why there was rapid progress in Public Health between 1800 and 1900. [12 marks • 30 mins]**

Medieval England: 1066–1485

Year 7 | How was power won, maintained, and contested in Medieval England?

🌀 **SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION)** CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

MONARCHY, LAW & STATE POWER
Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

FEUDAL ECONOMY & MILITARY TECH
Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

CATHOLIC HEGEMONY & IDEOLOGY
Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

POPULAR & BARONIAL RESISTANCE
Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 **1066 & The Battle of Hastings: Why did William win?** 🎯 CAUSATION & BATTLEFIELD TACTICS	• Assess the rival claims to the English throne in 1066. • Explain the tactical turning points of the Battle of Hastings. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: If bloodline succession was not legally established in 1066, what gave a medieval claimant true legitimacy: election, oaths, or military force?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Harold Swearing the Sacred Oath to William (c. 1070s); Source B: The Bayeux Tapestry: Death of King Harold & Flight of the Saxons (1066) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Explain why William of Normandy achieved victory at the Battle of Hastings in 1066. [12 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Explain why William of Normandy achieved victory at the Battle of Hastings in 1066. [12 marks]**
Lesson 2 **Castles, Terror & Domesday: How did the Normans subjugate England?** 🎯 HISTORICAL ANALYSIS: CONTROL & SUBJUGATION	• Explain how motte-and-bailey castles functioned as weapons of subjugation. • Analyse the significance of the Domesday audit in disinheriting the English. *Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Was a motte-and-bailey castle primarily a defensive shelter for knights, or an offensive weapon of terror designed to control the surrounding population?*	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Bayeux Tapestry: Normans Building a Castle at Hastings (1066); Source B: Great Domesday Book Folio: Survey of the King's Manors (1086) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Describe two features of Norman motte-and-bailey castles. [4 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Describe two features of Norman motte-and-bailey castles. [4 marks]**

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 3 **Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?** 🎯 HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & CHURCH-STATE CONFLICT	• Explain the conflict between Canon Law and royal courts over criminous clerks. • Analyse the causes and consequences of Becket's martyrdom. ***Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Was Henry II trying to modernize the legal system, or was he attempting an authoritarian power grab over the Catholic Church?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Manuscript Illumination of King Henry II and Thomas Becket Clashing (c. 1300s); Source B: Eyewitness Account of the Murder of Thomas Becket by Edward Grim (1170) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Question 3(b) & 3(c): Contrasting Interpretations [8 marks • 10 mins] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.**
Lesson 4 **Magna Carta (1215) & Medieval Kingship: Liberty or Barons' Power Grab?** 🎯 HISTORICAL INTERPRETATION: LIBERTY VS SELF-INTEREST	• Explain the financial and military pressures that pushed the barons into rebellion. • Evaluate the dual nature of Magna Carta: feudal self-interest versus constitutional legacy. ***Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Was John an unusually evil king, or an unlucky administrator struggling to finance modern warfare on an outdated feudal budget?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: Matthew Paris, Chronicle Portrait of King John (c. 1250); Source B: Magna Carta: Verbatim Clauses 39 and 40 (1215) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the loss of Normandy (1204) to the sealing of Magna Carta (1215). [8 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the loss of Normandy (1204) to the sealing of Magna Carta (1215). [8 marks]**
Lesson 5 **The Black Death (1348) & The Peasants' Revolt (1381): How did plague and rebellion shatter feudalism?** 🎯 CAUSAL LINKS & SOCIO-ECONOMIC CHANGE	• Explain the economic chain reaction connecting the Black Death to the labour crisis. • Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or long-term success. ***Discussion Prompt: Hinge Question: Why did the Black Death empower ordinary peasant workers when kings and bishops remained in power?***	📜 **PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:** Source A: The Statute of Labourers Parliamentary Statute Extract (1351); Source B: Jean Froissart: The Death of Wat Tyler at Smithfield (c. 1380s) ⚖️ **DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:** 'The Black Death of 1348 was the main cause of the breakdown of the feudal system in medieval England.' How far do you agree? [12 marks] ✍️ **CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:** **[Evaluative Enquiry] 'The Black Death of 1348 was the main cause of the breakdown of the feudal system in medieval England.' How far do you agree? [12 marks]**